

RTS

Request To Send. An RTS is a message sent by a networked device to its access point, seeking permission to send a data packet. See also RTS threshold.

RTS Threshold

Request To Send threshold. The RTS threshold specifies the packet size of an RTS transmission. This helps control traffic flow through an access point, especially one with many clients.

Server

The ‘business’ end of a client/server setup, a server is usually a computer that provides the information, files, Web pages, and other services to the client that logs on to it. The word server is also used to describe the software and operating system designed to run server hardware.

SLIP

Serial Line Internet Protocol; a standard for connecting to the Internet with a modem over a phone line. It has serious trouble with noisy dial-up lines and other error-prone connections.

Spread spectrum

A wireless communications technology that scatters data transmissions across the available frequency band in a pseudorandom pattern. Spreading the data across the frequency spectrum greatly increases the bandwidth (the amount of data that can be transmitted at one time), and it also makes the signal resistant to noise, interference, and snooping. Spread-spectrum modulation schemes are commonly used with personal communications devices such as digital cellular phones, as well as with WLANs and cable modems. See FHSS, DSSS, and CDMA for examples of spread-spectrum techniques.

SSID

Service Set Identifier. Every wireless network or network subset, such as a BSS, ESS, or IBSS, has a unique identifier called an SSID